



Computer Communication Laboratory Seminar

Satisfaction-Aware Resource Allocation for Integrated OIRS-aided HAP and sub-THz Access Networks

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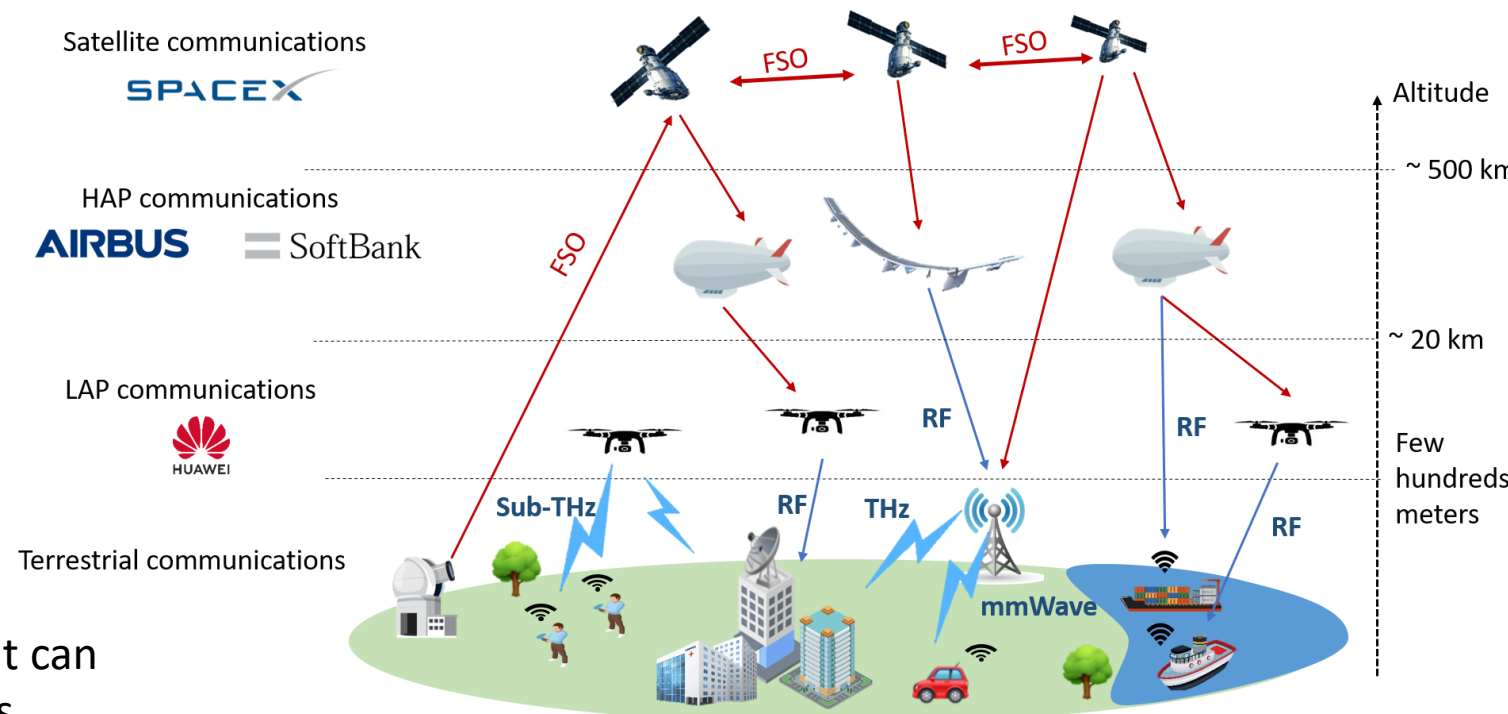
Aizuwakamatsu, June 17, 2026

Outline of Presentation

- I. Research Background
- II. System Model
- III. Challenges and Research Goals
- IV. Proposed Resource Allocation
- V. Performance Metrics and Initial Results
- VI. Conclusion and Future Improvements

1. Research Background: 6G Vision for Network Architectures and Communication Technologies

- ❑ Future 6G networks are expected to support **ubiquitous connectivity** and **high-data services**, even in remote, rural, and hard-to-reach areas.
- ❑ Non-terrestrial networks (NTNs) *using satellites, HAPs and UAVs* can **extend service coverage beyond terrestrial infrastructure**, especially useful for connecting rural and remote areas.
- ❑ FSO backhaul (GS-> NTN-> UAV):
 - Use near-infrared light to transmit data
 - Extremely high data rate (Gbps to Tbps).
- ❑ Access (UAV/BS -> end users):
 - Incorporate RF/mmWave/THz/sub-THz
 - Sub-THz access is recently attracted because it can provide large bandwidth for high-rate services.



➡ **The integration of FSO backhaul-based NTNs and sub-THz access can provide **large coverage** and **high-data-rate service**.**

1. Research Background: The Optical IRS-assisted FSO-based NTN

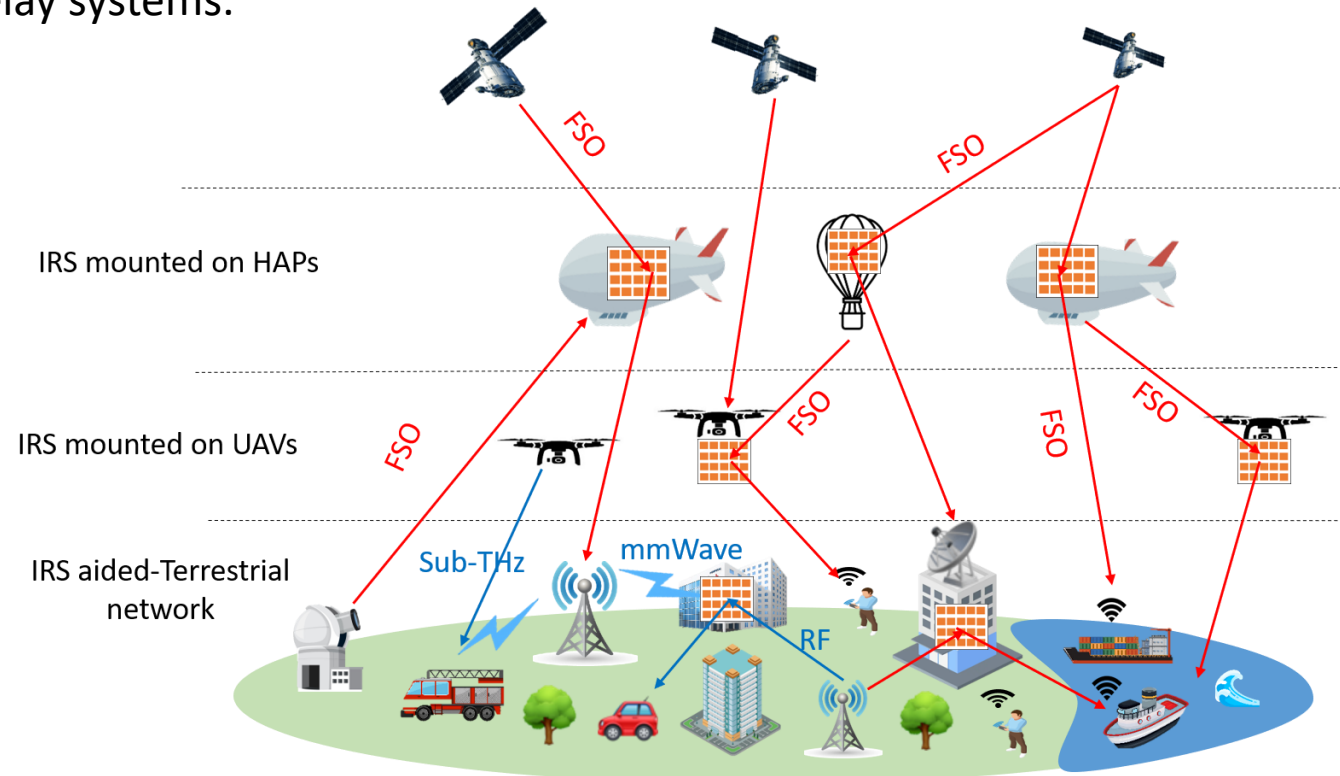
- ❑ FSO backhaul is attractive for high-capacity aerial networks, but relay-based FSO systems have strict limits on cost, size, weight, and power consumption (C-SWaP) and hardware complexity.
- ❑ To relax this limitation, many studies have developed **optical intelligent reflecting surfaces (OIRS)** as a potential technology to *serve as a lightweight alternative* to conventional relay systems.

❖ Optical Intelligent Reflecting Surface (OIRS)

- A passive surface with mirrors or meta-atoms *reflects FSO beam* in a *controlled way.*
- Possible to simultaneously support multiple users

❖ Advantage compared to relay systems

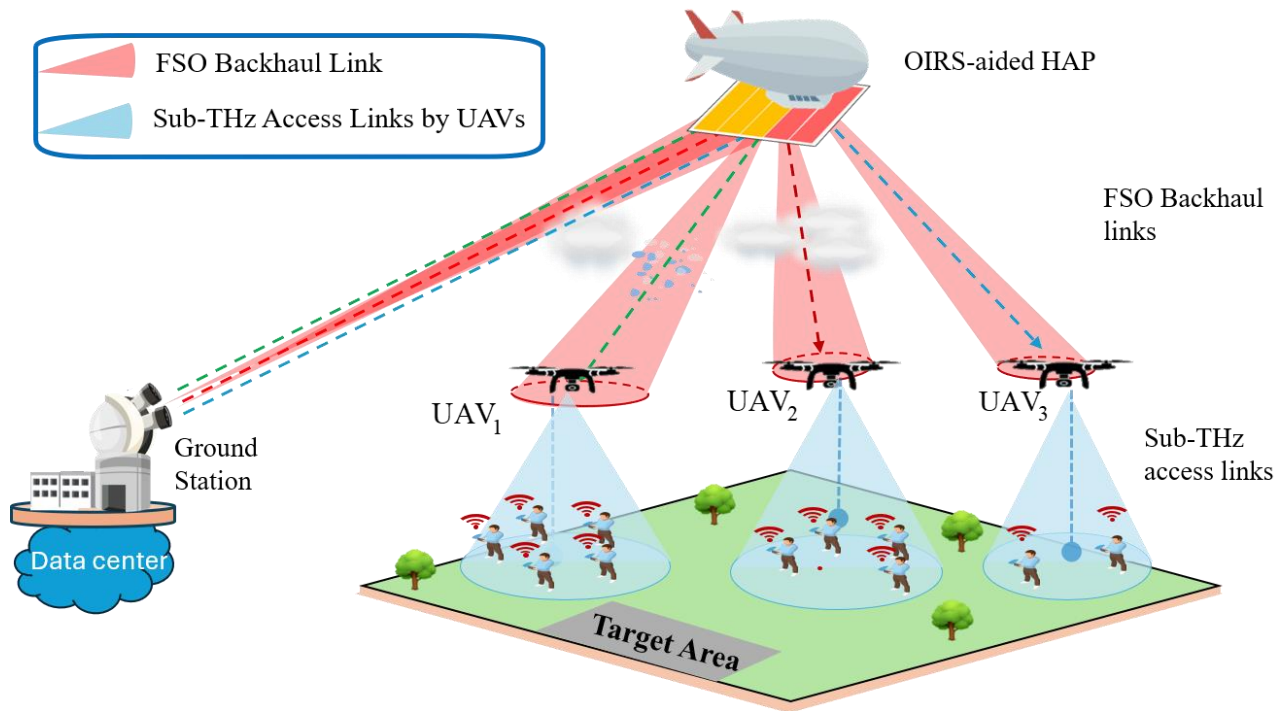
- Lightweight, low cost
- Low power consumption
- Extend coverage, avoid blockage



The operation concept of optical IRS

➡ The HAP-mounted OIRS can assist multiple UAVs backhaul links by allocating OIRS blocks, enabling flexible high-capacity FSO backhaul.

2. System Model: Integrated OIRS-aided HAP and sub-THz Access network



Integrated OIRS-aided HAP and Sub-THz Access Networks

FSO Backhaul side

Ground station → HAP-mounted OIRS → N fixed UAVs

The OIRS comprises N_B blocks for allocation

Sub-THz Access side

Each UAV acts as an aerial hotspot base station serving ground users.

UAV hotspots are assumed to be spatially separated

End-to-end service

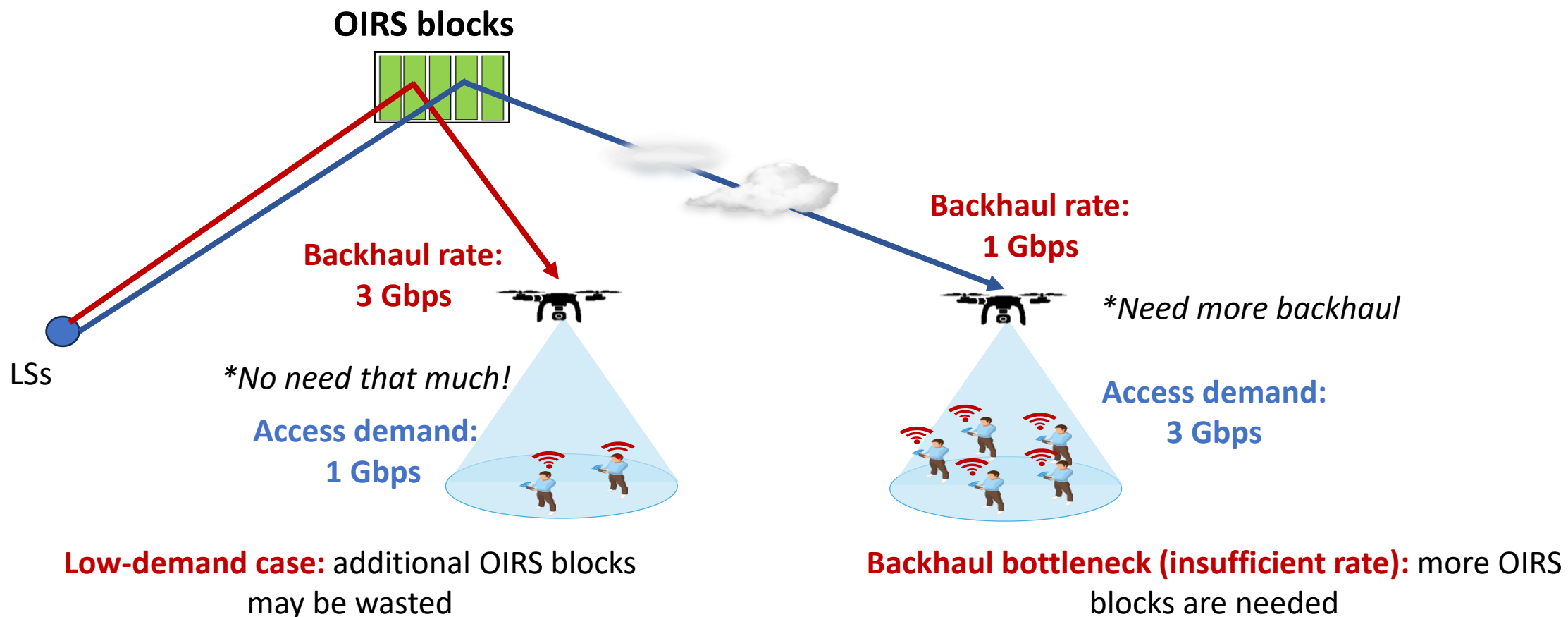
Ground users request different services (VR/web browser/download app...)

The HAP/OIRS allocates UAV-level backhaul capacity, while each UAV performs user-level sub-THz scheduling.

3. Challenges in Integrated OIRS-aided HAP and sub-THz Access network

□ 3.1 Access-Backhaul Traffic Mismatch

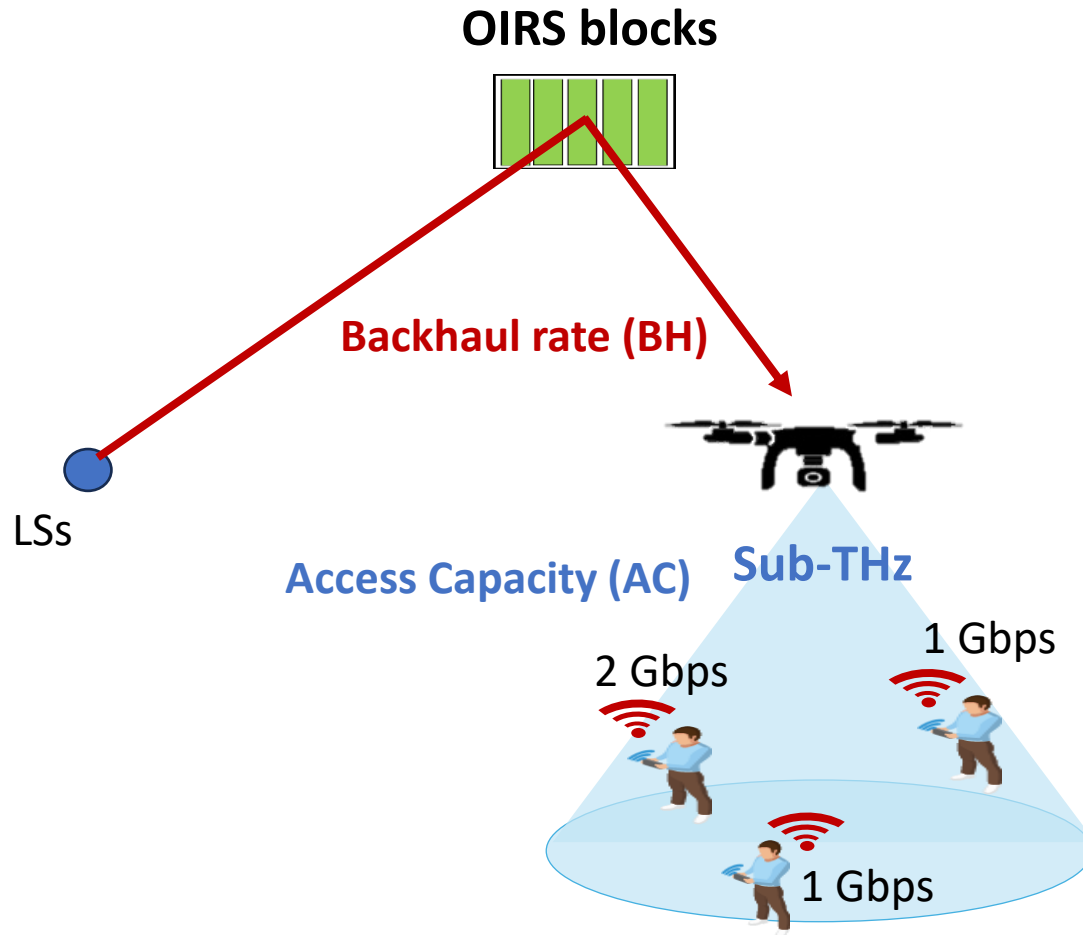
- Due to C-SWaP, **OIRS blocks** mounted on HAP are **limited and shared among N UAVs**



➡ OIRS allocation should consider both *backhaul channel condition* and *UAV-side access demand/capability*.

3. Challenges in Integrated OIRS-aided HAP and sub-THz Access network

❑ 3.2 Limited Power and Bandwidth in sub-THz Access



❖ Each UAV has limited power and available bandwidth

- Power and bandwidth should be allocated to users according to demand, channel condition, and available backhaul.
- If backhaul-limited case: access capacity > backhaul capacity,
 - Example: BH 2Gbps, AC 4Gbps, Demand 4Gbps
-> Using full bandwidth and power may be wasted
- If access-limited case: access capacity is not sufficient
 - Example: BH 4Gbps, AC 2Gbps, Demand 4Gbps
-> more backhaul cannot increase served traffic
-> bandwidth and power need to be allocated to users

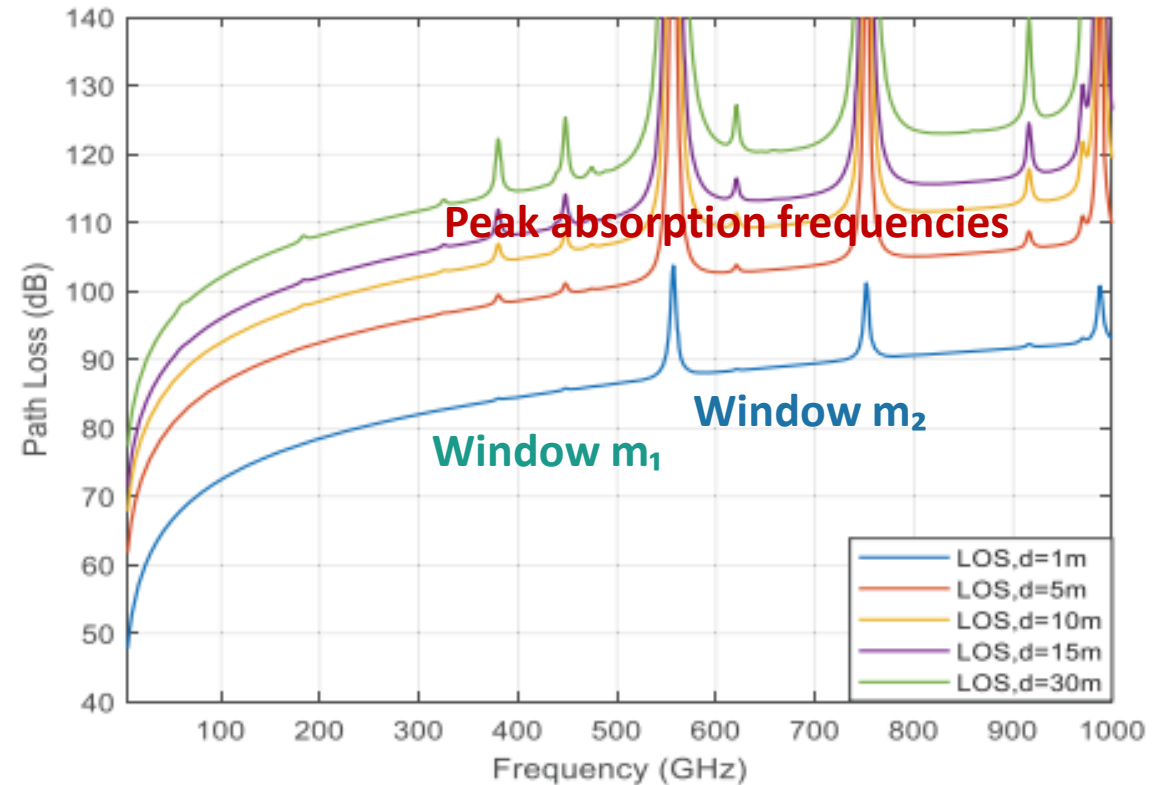


Power, bandwidth allocation and OIRS allocation should be jointly designed with user demands

3. Challenges in Integrated OIRS-aided HAP and sub-THz Access network

3.3 Sub-THz Impairments

- In sub-THz access links, the achievable rate strongly depends on user distance, channel condition, and selected frequency window.
 - Beam spreading loss: weaker signal by distance
 - Small-scale fading: instantaneous channel gains
 - Molecular absorption: air molecules absorb signal energy



Window m_1

Lower absorption
Suitable for long-distance users
Possibly limited usable bandwidth

Window m_2

Higher frequency
Potentially larger bandwidth
More sensitive to distance

Decision

Allocate frequency windows
based on user distance,
channel, and demand

3. Challenges in Integrated OIRS-aided HAP and Sub-THz Access network

□ 3.4 Dynamic Users and Historical Satisfaction State

- Due to user mobility, time-varying channel, and limited resources, some users **may be unserved (low satisfaction)** repeatedly.
- **End-to-end demand satisfaction of user k** associated with UAVi:

$$\rho_{i,k}(t) = \frac{\text{Served rate}}{\text{Demand}} = \frac{s_{i,k}(t)}{D_{i,k}^{\text{req}}(t) + \delta}, \quad 0 \leq \rho_{i,k}(t) \leq 1.$$

- $\rho_{i,k}(t) = 1$, the demand of user k is fully served.
 - $\rho_{i,k}(t)$ is close to 0, only a small portion of the requested traffic is served.
- Historical satisfaction is used to record past service quality.
 - Users with low historical satisfaction receive larger priority weights in later slots.

-> Historical satisfaction state and priority weight increase the chance that repeatedly underserved users receive resources in later slots

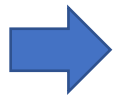
3. Research Gaps and Goals

Refs	System Model	Main Objective	OIRS-FSO Backhaul	Integrated Access/Backhaul	sub-THz Access	Traffic-Aware Demand Satisfaction	Moving Cloud/ Multi-HAP
UAV RF access [1]-[3]	UAV-assisted RF access	UAV placement / trajectory to maximize covered users, throughput, or user satisfaction	X	△	X	△	X
OIRS-assisted FSO backhaul [4]	OIRS-assisted FSO backhaul	Improve FSO capacity, outage, or link reliability	✓	X	X	X	△
OIRS allocation Backhaul [5]	HAP-OIRS-UAV FSO backhaul	Maximize number of supported UAVs under fixed target backhaul rate	✓	X	X	X	✓
Integrated FSO/RF access [6]-[10]	UAV IAB with RF/mmWave access	Joint UAV placement / trajectory / bandwidth allocation	△	✓	X	△	△
OIRS-HAP + UAV RF access under clouds [11]-[12]	HAP-OIRS FSO backhaul + UAV RF access	Maximize number of supported users under dynamic users/clouds	✓	✓	X	△	✓
THz/sub-THz access networks [13]-[14]	THz/sub-THz Base Station/UAV	Transmission-window selection, sub-band assignment, power allocation, user association	X	△	✓	△	X
This work	HAP-OIRS FSO backhaul + UAV sub-THz access	Maximize weighted end-to-end user satisfaction	✓	✓	✓	✓	Future extension: ✓

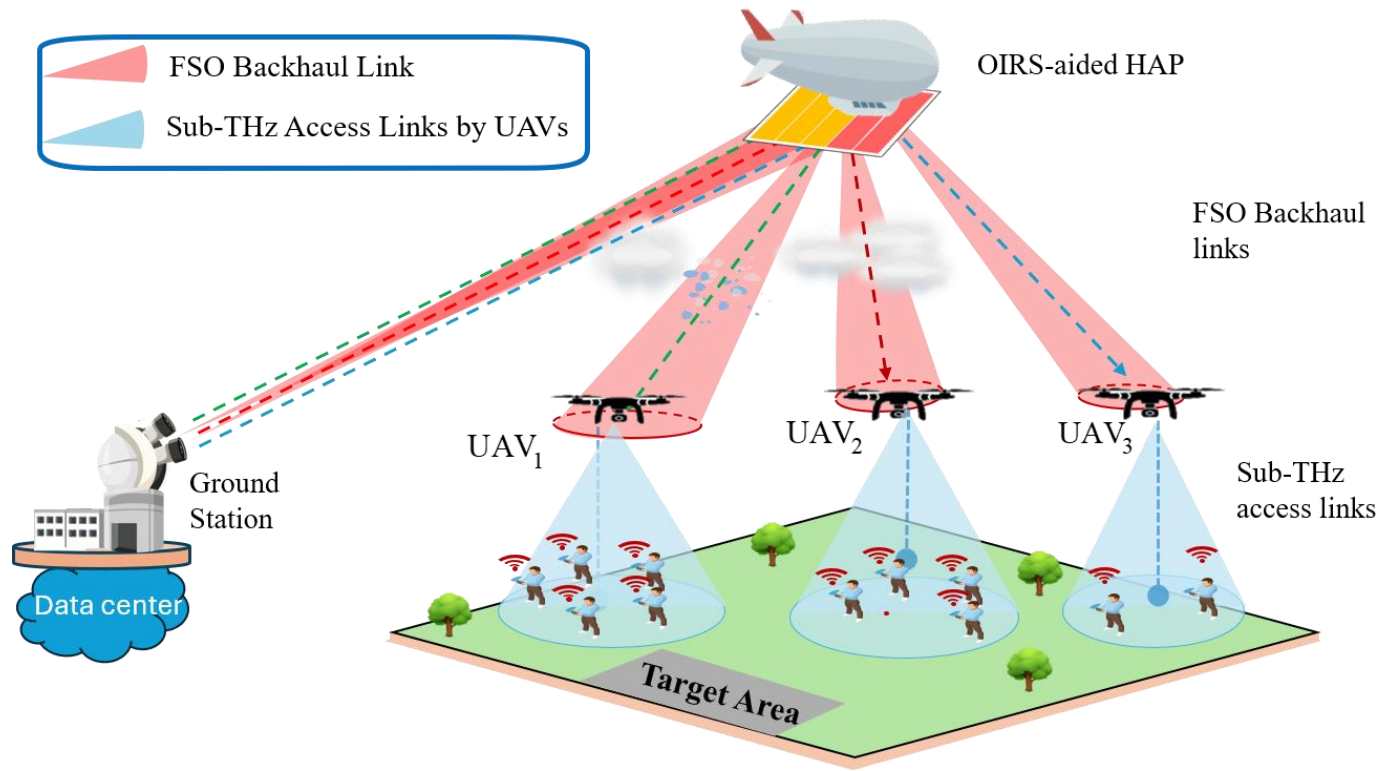
✓: explicitly considered

△: partially considered /simplified

X: not considered

 This work designs *a satisfaction-aware resource allocation scheme* that jointly considers *OIRS block allocation, sub-THz power/bandwidth/frequency-window allocation, and historical user satisfaction to improve end-to-end users' satisfaction.*

4. Proposed Resource Allocation: Systems Variables



- Number of users associated with UAV_i

$$K_i(t) \sim \text{Poisson}(\lambda_i(t))$$

- Per-user requested traffic demand

$$d_{i,k}(t) \in \{d_{\text{IoT}}, d_{\text{video}}, d_{\text{eMBB}}, d_{\text{emergency}}\}$$

- Backhaul rate with n allocated blocks

$$R_i^{\text{BH}}(n_i; t) = B_{\text{FSO}} \log_2 (1 + \gamma_i^{\text{FSO}}(n_i; t))$$

- The achievable sub-THz access rate of user k associated with UAV_i, given allocated power p_i and bandwidth b_i

$$R_{i,k}^{\text{AC}}(\mathbf{p}_i, \mathbf{b}_i; t) = \sum_{m \in \mathcal{M}} b_{i,k,m}(t) \times \log_2 \left(1 + \frac{p_{i,k,m}(t) g_{i,k,m}(t)}{b_{i,k,m}(t) [N_0 + N_{\text{mol}}(f_m, d_{i,k}(t))]} \right),$$

- f_m is the center frequency of window m ,
- N_0 is the thermal noise power spectral density, $N_{\text{mol}}(f_m, d_{i,k}(t))$ denotes the molecular absorption noise over the sub-THz link,
- $g_{i,k,m}(t)$ is the channel gain.

4. Proposed Resource Allocation: Served Traffic and Utility

□ End-to-end served traffic and satisfaction ratio:

- We define the actual end-to-end served rate of user k associated with UAV i

$$s_{i,k}(t) = \min(R_{i,k}^{\text{AC}}(\mathbf{p}_i, \mathbf{b}_i; t), D_{i,k}^{\text{req}}(t))$$

- Total end-to-end served rate of all users associated with UAV i

$$\sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}_i(t)} s_{i,k}(t) \leq R_i^{\text{BH}}(n_i; t),$$

- **End-to-end demand satisfaction of user k** associated with UAV i :

$$\rho_{i,k}(t) = \frac{\text{Served rate}}{\text{Demand}} = \frac{s_{i,k}(t)}{D_{i,k}^{\text{req}}(t) + \delta},$$

- **Per-user satisfaction-aware utility:**

$$u_{i,k}(t) = \ln(1 + \rho_{i,k}(t)).$$

4. Proposed Resource Allocation: Historical Satisfaction and Priority Weight

□ *For each user k associated with UAV i , we consider not only current satisfaction but also past service quality*

- The target satisfaction is ρ^{tar}
- The historical satisfaction state is updated by: $\bar{\rho}_{i,k}(t+1) = (1 - \alpha)\bar{\rho}_{i,k}(t) + \alpha\rho_{i,k}(t),$
- The satisfaction deficit is $d_{i,k}^{\text{his}}(t) = [\rho^{\text{tar}} - \bar{\rho}_{i,k}(t)]^+,$
- *The normalized historical priority weight of each user k associated with UAV i :*

$$w_{i,k}(t) = K_{\text{tot}}(t) \frac{1 + \eta d_{i,k}^{\text{his}}(t)}{\sum_{j \in \mathcal{I}} \sum_{\ell \in \mathcal{K}_j(t)} [1 + \eta d_{j,\ell}^{\text{his}}(t)]},$$

- α : controls how much the current satisfaction affects the historical state.
- η : controls how strongly historical deficit increases priority.
- Newly active users are initialized with $\bar{\rho}_{i,k}(t) = \rho^{\text{tar}}$

-> By incorporating per-user utility function and priority weights, we can formulate objective problem

4. Proposed Resource Allocation: Optimization Problem

□ Optimization Problem:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{P1 : } \quad & \max_{n, p, b, \rho} \sum_{i \in \mathcal{I}} \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}_i(t)} w_{i,k}(t) \ln(1 + \rho_{i,k}(t)) && \longleftarrow \text{Maximize weighted end-to-end satisfaction} \\ \text{s.t. } \quad & \rho_{i,k}(t) = \frac{s_{i,k}(t)}{D_{i,k}^{\text{req}}(t) + \delta}, \quad \forall i \in \mathcal{I}, k \in \mathcal{K}_i(t), \\ & 0 \leq s_{i,k}(t) \leq D_{i,k}^{\text{req}}(t), \quad \forall i \in \mathcal{I}, k \in \mathcal{K}_i(t), && \longleftarrow \text{Served traffic constraints} \\ & s_{i,k}(t) \leq R_{i,k}^{\text{AC}}(\mathbf{p}_i, \mathbf{b}_i; t), \quad \forall i \in \mathcal{I}, k \in \mathcal{K}_i(t), && \longleftarrow \text{Served traffic constraints} \\ & \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}_i(t)} s_{i,k}(t) \leq R_i^{\text{BH}}(n_i; t), \quad \forall i \in \mathcal{I}, && \longleftarrow \text{Backhaul constraint} \\ & \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}_i(t)} \sum_{m \in \mathcal{M}} p_{i,k,m}(t) \leq P_i^{\text{U}}, \quad \forall i \in \mathcal{I}, && \longleftarrow \text{UAV power constraints} \\ & \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}_i(t)} b_{i,k,m}(t) \leq B_m, \quad \forall i \in \mathcal{I}, m \in \mathcal{M}, && \longleftarrow \text{UAV bandwidth constraints} \\ & \sum_{i \in \mathcal{I}} n_i(t) \leq N_B, && \longleftarrow \text{OIRS block budget} \\ & p_{i,k,m}(t) \geq 0, \quad b_{i,k,m}(t) \geq 0, \quad s_{i,k}(t) > 0. \\ & n_i(t) \in \mathbb{Z}_+, \quad \forall i \in \mathcal{I}. \end{aligned}$$

4. Proposed Resource Allocation: Algorithm

□ Algorithm: Hierarchical Value-Function-Based Allocation

- Key idea: allocate each OIRS block to UAV where additional backhaul can *most effectively improve weighted user satisfaction*.
- 2 levels optimization: HAP-level (dynamic programming) + local UAV scheduling (convex optimization)

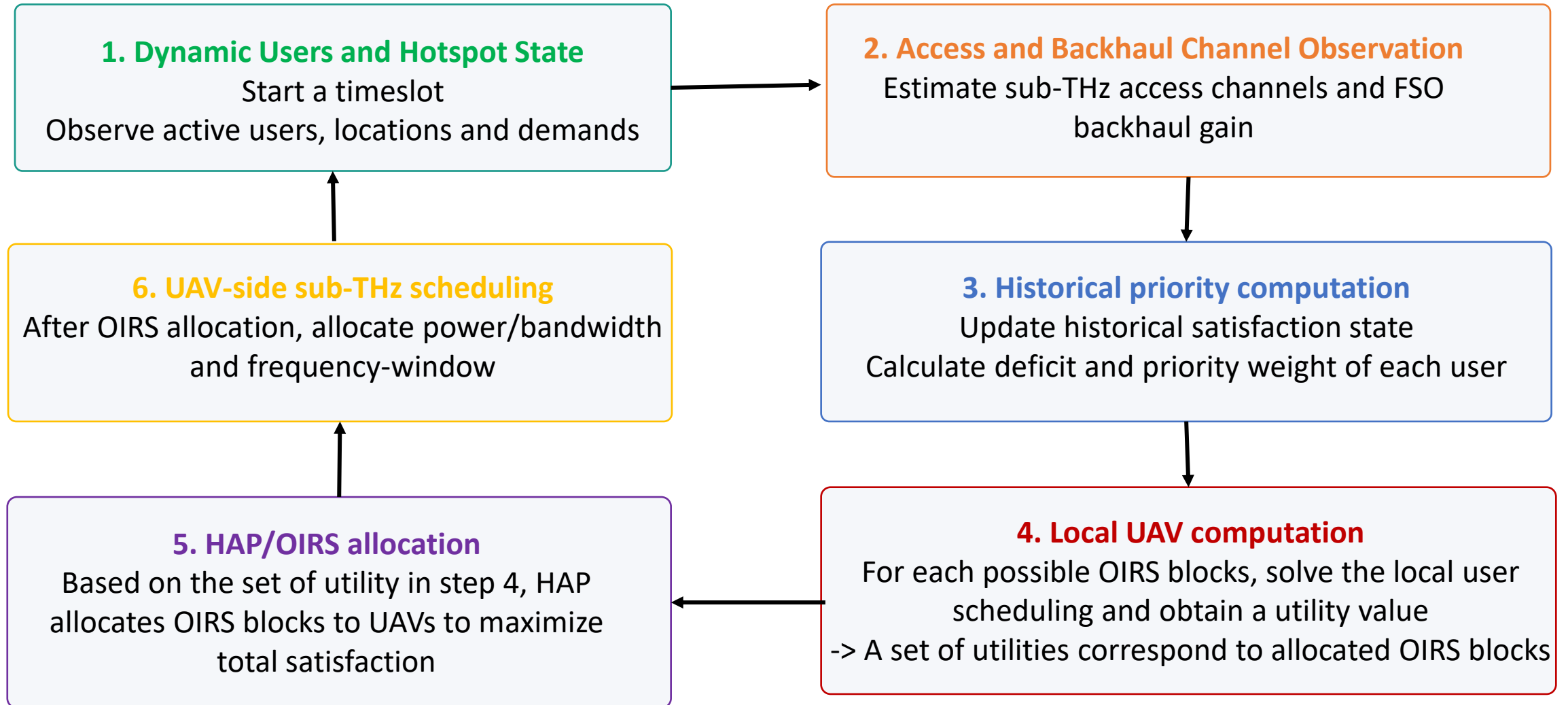
□ How the system behaves:

- **Behavior 1:** backhaul-limited UAV needs more backhaul to serve access demand
-> allocate more blocks
- **Behavior 2:** access-limited UAV, giving more backhaul is not very useful
-> allocate less blocks
- **Behavior 3:** low-satisfaction user are favored
-> small resource can gain high satisfaction
- **Behavior 4:** historically underserved user receive larger priority weights
-> Historical weights increase the priority of users served poorly in previous slots.

Algorithm 1 Hierarchical Value-Function-Based OIRS Allocation

```
1: Input: Active user sets  $\{\mathcal{K}_i(t)\}$ , user demands  $\{D_{i,k}^{\text{req}}(t)\}$ ,  
   sub-THz channel states  $\{g_{i,k,m}(t)\}$ , backhaul rate func-  
   tions  $\{R_i^{\text{BH}}(q; t)\}$ , historical states  $\{\bar{\rho}_{i,k}(t)\}$ , and total  
   OIRS blocks  $N_B$   
2: Compute historical weights  $\{w_{i,k}(t)\}$  according to (56)–  
   (57)  
3: for each UAV  $i \in \mathcal{I}$  do  
4:   for  $q = 0$  to  $N_B$  do  
5:     Solve the local UAV problem (62) with  $q$  OIRS  
     blocks  
6:     Store the obtained value  $F_i(q; t)$   
7:   end for  
8: end for  
9: Initialize  $V(0, \ell) = 0$  for all  $\ell = 0, \dots, N_B$   
10: for  $i = 1$  to  $|\mathcal{I}|$  do  
11:   for  $\ell = 0$  to  $N_B$  do  
12:      $V(i, \ell) = \max_{0 \leq q \leq \ell} \{V(i-1, \ell-q) + F_i(q; t)\}$   
13:     Store the selected  $q$  for backtracking  
14:   end for  
15: end for  
16: Obtain the optimal OIRS block allocation  $\{n_i^*(t)\}$  by  
   backtracking  
17: Apply the corresponding local access allocation  
    $\{\mathbf{p}_i^*, \mathbf{b}_i^*, \mathbf{s}_i^*\}$   
18: for each UAV  $i \in \mathcal{I}$  do  
19:   for each active user  $k \in \mathcal{K}_i(t)$  do  
20:     Compute  $\rho_{i,k}(t)$  using (52)  
21:     Update  $\bar{\rho}_{i,k}(t+1)$  using (54)  
22:   end for  
23: end for  
24: Output: OIRS block allocation  $\{n_i^*(t)\}$  and UAV-side  
   access scheduling variables  $\{\mathbf{p}_i^*, \mathbf{b}_i^*, \mathbf{s}_i^*\}$ 
```

4. Proposed Resource Allocation: Protocol Flow



5. Performance Metrics and Benchmarks

□ Performance metrics:

- Total end-user satisfaction utility:
$$U_{\text{total}}(t) = \sum_{i \in \mathcal{I}} \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}_i(t)} w_{i,k}(t) \ln(1 + \rho_{i,k}(t)).$$
- Average end-user satisfaction:
$$\rho_{\text{avg}}(t) = \frac{1}{K_{\text{tot}}(t)} \sum_{i \in \mathcal{I}} \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}_i(t)} \rho_{i,k}(t).$$
- Total served rate:
$$S_{\text{total}}(t) = \sum_{i \in \mathcal{I}} \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}_i(t)} s_{i,k}(t).$$
- Satisfied-user ratio:
$$\Gamma(t) = \frac{K_{\text{sat}}(t)}{K_{\text{tot}}(t)}.$$

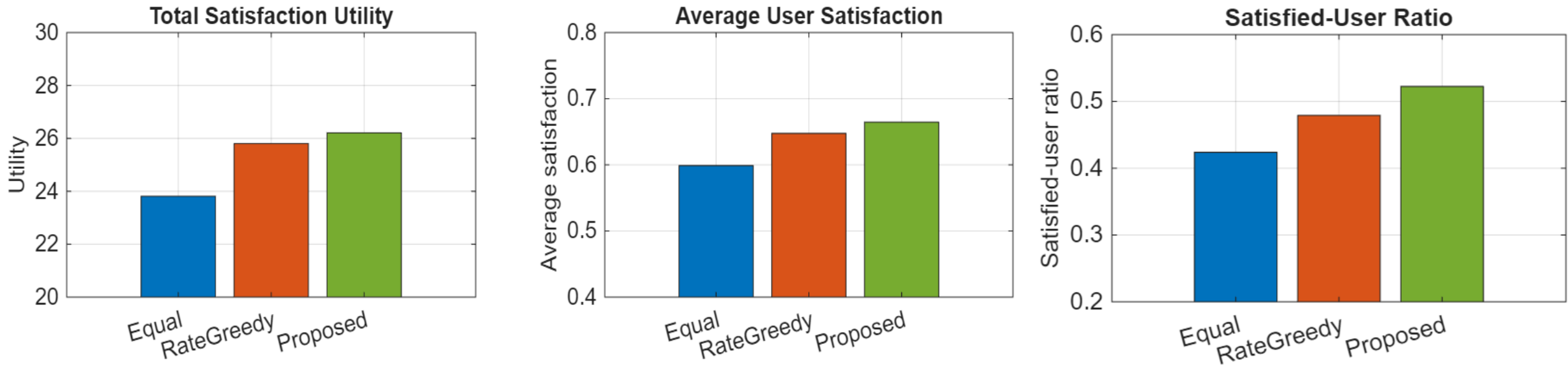
□ To evaluate our proposed scheme, we compare it with two benchmarks:

- (1) **Rate-based Greedy Allocation (RGA)**: allocate OIRS according to the highest marginal served-rate gain.
- (2) **Uniform Element Allocation (UEA)**: the OIRS is shared equally among all UAVs.

□ Parameters: 5 UAVs with [15, 5, 12, 8, 10] users, respectively.

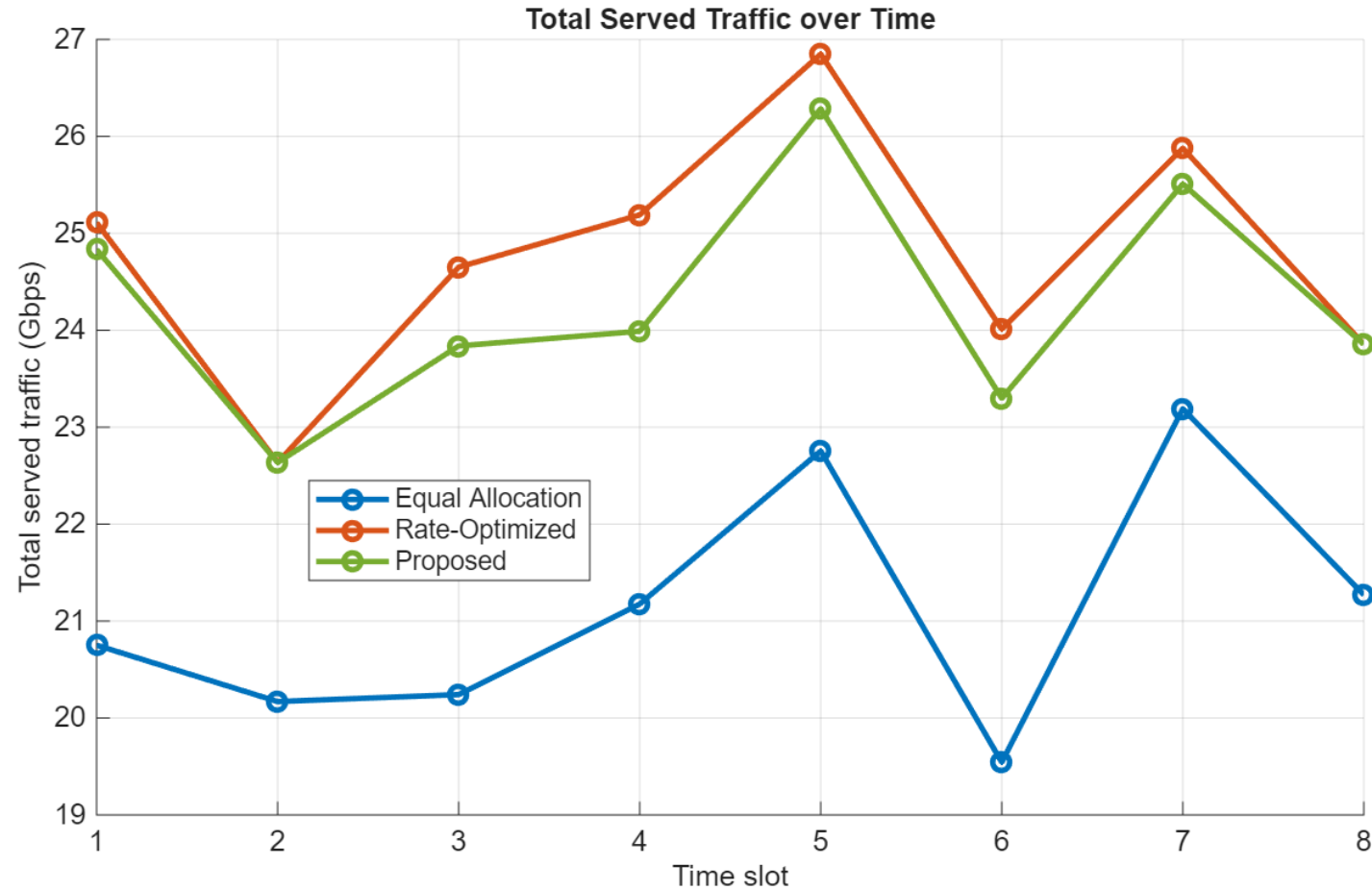
- Service rate classes of users = [100 Mbps, 600Mbps, 1Gbps, 2Gbps];
- Cloud liquid water content = [0.5, 2, 1.5, 1.5, 0.5];

5. The Effectiveness of the Proposed Satisfaction-Aware Resource Allocation



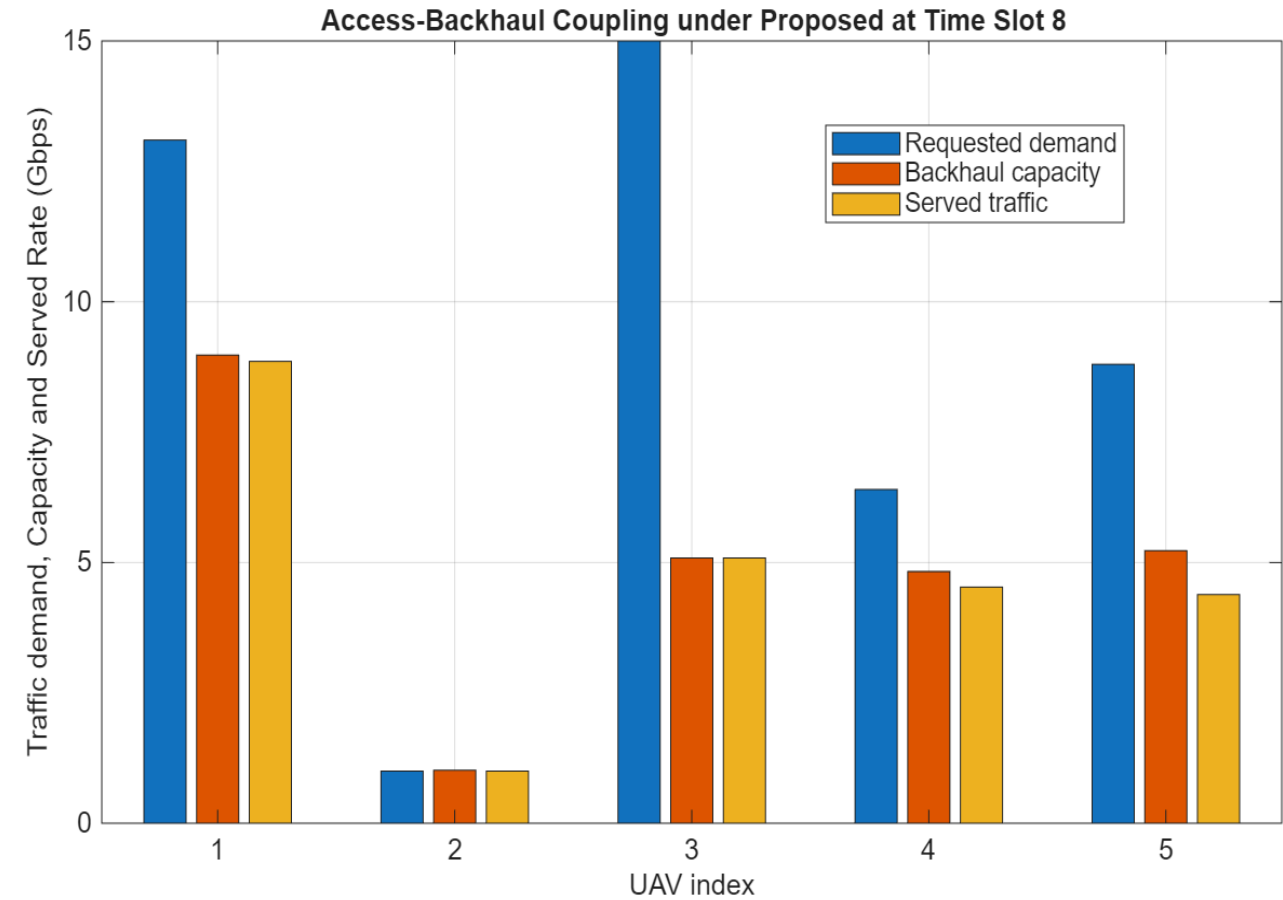
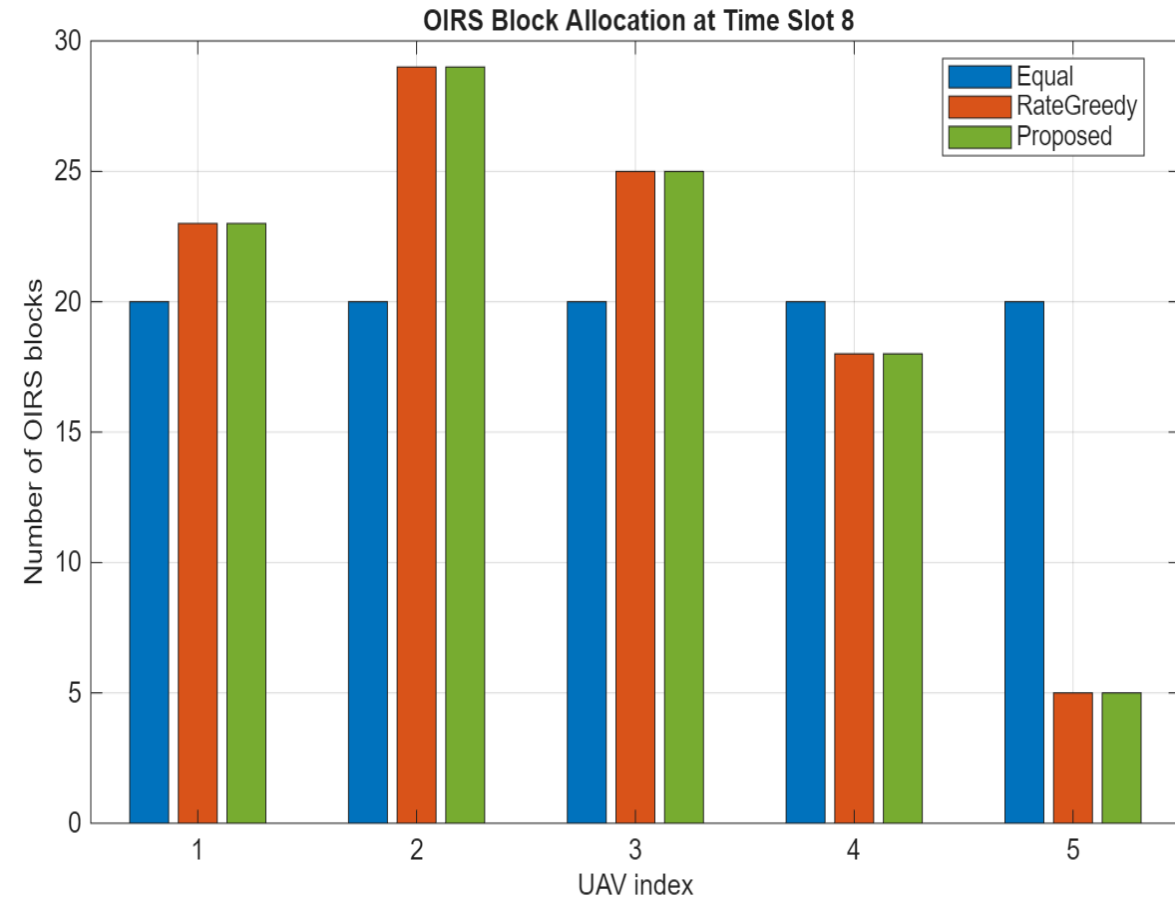
- The proposed allocation *outperforms other schemes by:*
 - *Highest total satisfaction*
 - *Average user satisfaction is improved*
 - *Number of satisfied users (user achieves target satisfaction) is increased*

5. The Rate-Satisfaction Tradeoff



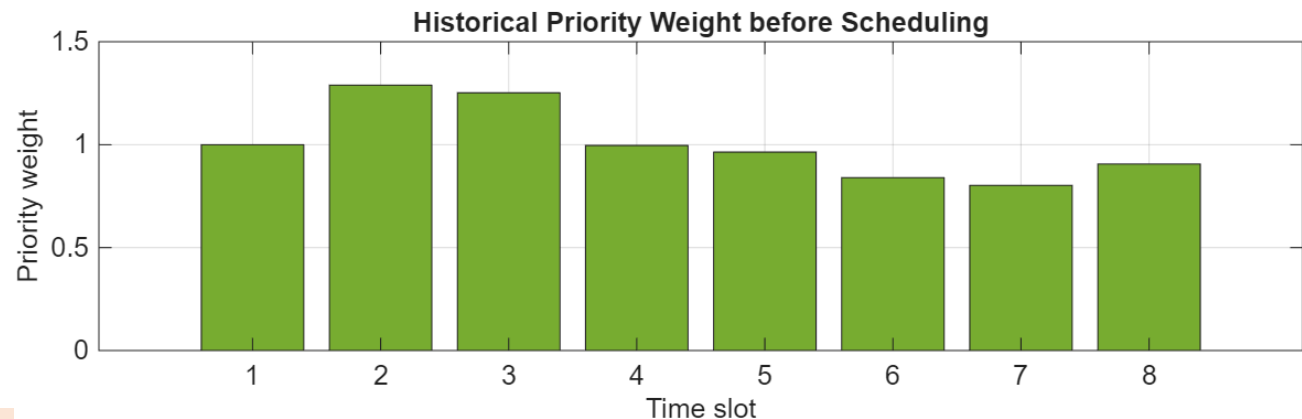
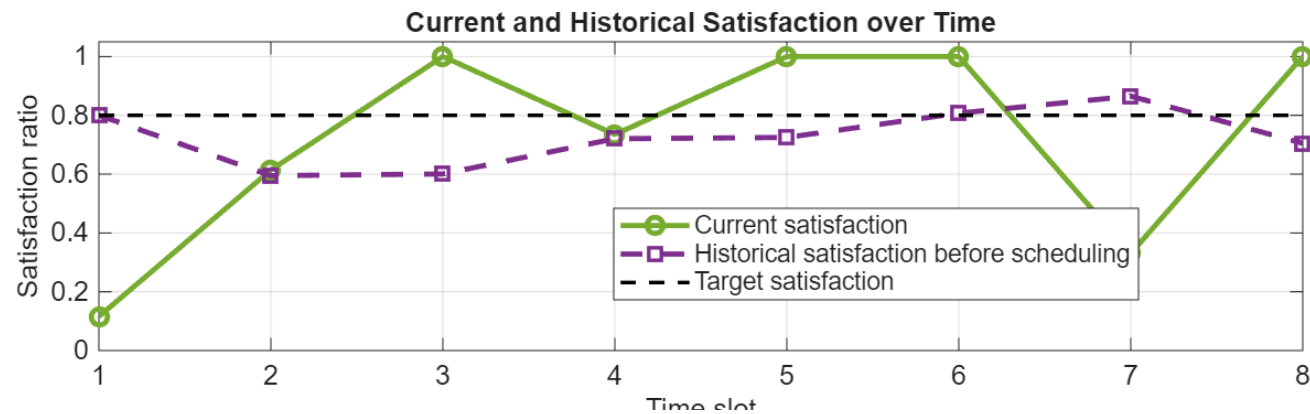
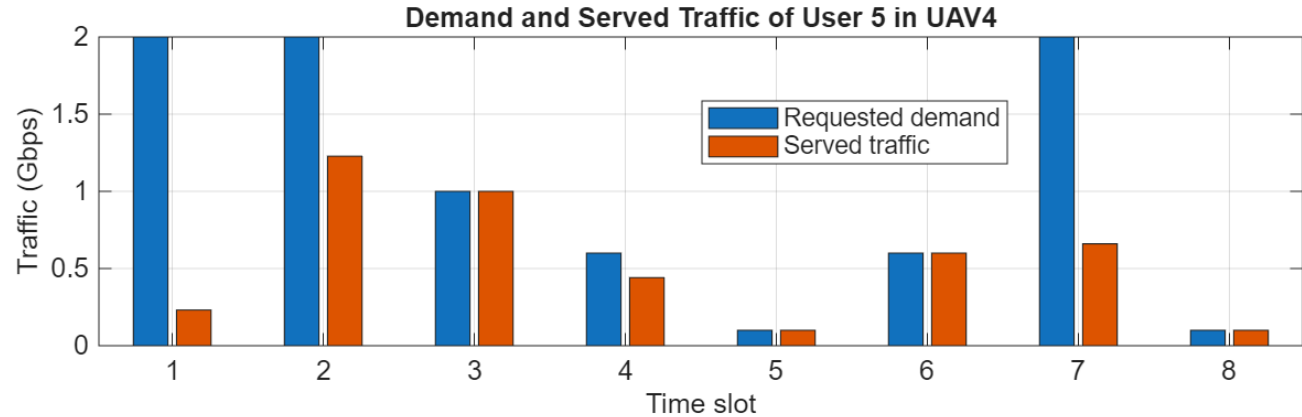
- Although the proposed allocation *can provide higher total satisfaction, the total served rate is not optimized.*

5. OIRS Allocation Behavior in the Proposed Satisfaction-Aware



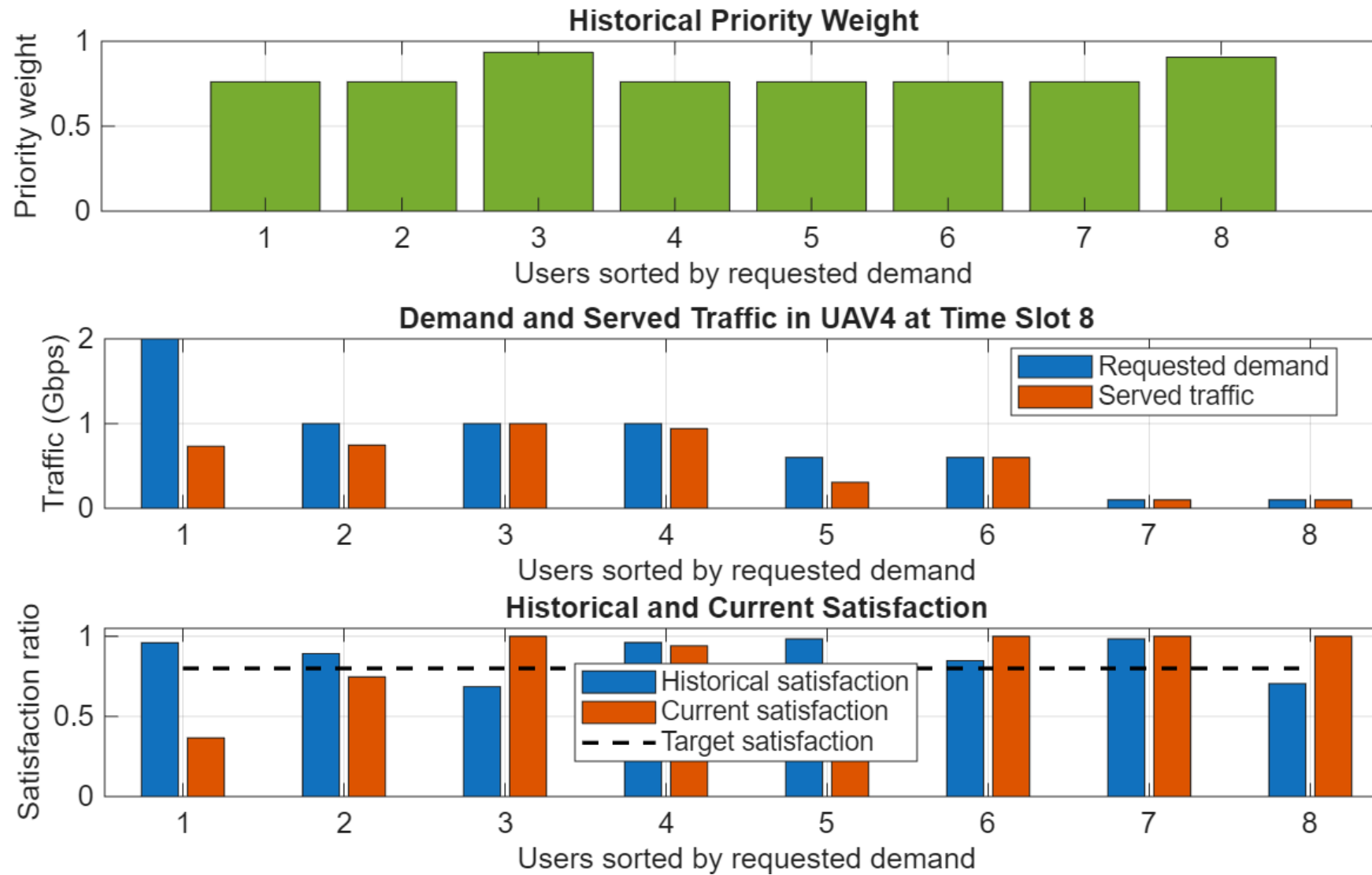
- OIRS blocks are allocated according to the expected improvement in user-level satisfaction, considering backhaul capacity, access capability, and user demand.

5. The Behavior of User 5 in UAV4



- *Timeslot 1: the user has low satisfaction*
- *Timeslot 2: its historical priority weight increases*
- *Timeslot 3: user reaches the target satisfaction*
- *Timeslots 4-5-6: give priority to other users -> the priority weight gradually decreases*
- *Timeslot 7: satisfaction is decreased again*
- *Timeslot 8: being served*

5. The Behavior of Each User in UAV4

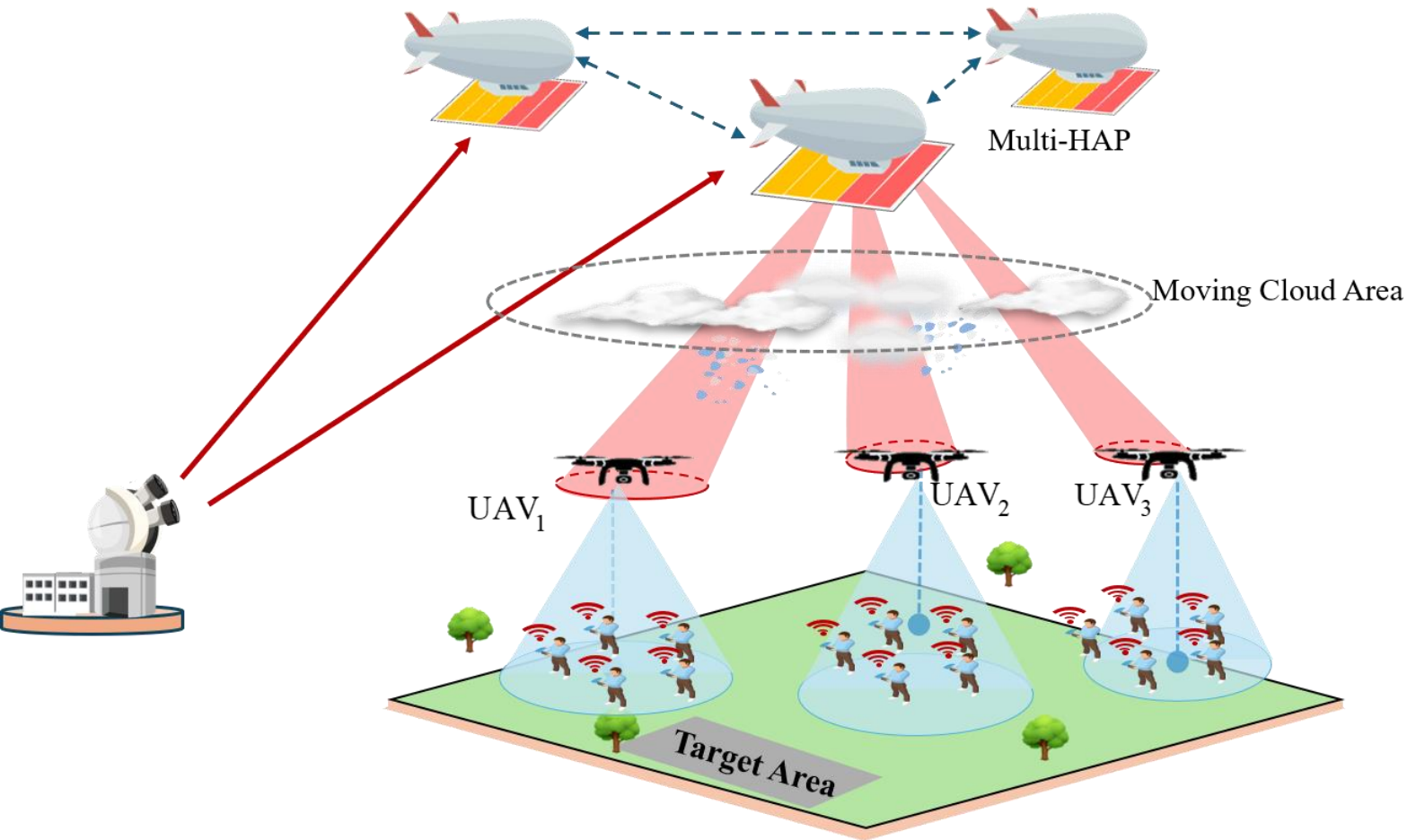


- Users with higher priority weights tend to receive more service.

6. Conclusion and Future Improvement

- In this work, we proposed a satisfaction-aware resource allocation scheme for integrated OIRS-aided HAP and sub-THz access networks.
 - The proposed scheme jointly considers OIRS block allocation, sub-THz access scheduling, and historical user satisfaction.
 - The proposed scheme *improves user-level satisfaction* and *satisfied-user coverage*, while showing a throughput-satisfaction tradeoff compared with rate-greedy allocation.
 - Numerical results confirmed the *effectiveness of proposed scheme* compared to conventional schemes.

6. Future Improvement: Multi-HAP and Cloud-Aware Availability



- FSO links are sensitive to clouds -> system's outage -> link diversity
- Multi-HAP extension: recent works focus on deploying multi-HAP to avoid clouds, improving outage probability



- Formulate another problem: select the best HAP to guarantee system's availability under moving cloud

6. Future Improvement: Faster Algorithm and System Extensions

$$\mathbf{P1} : \max_{n, p, b, \rho} \sum_{i \in \mathcal{I}} \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}_i(t)} w_{i,k}(t) \ln(1 + \rho_{i,k}(t)) \quad (61a)$$

$$\text{s.t. } \rho_{i,k}(t) = \frac{s_{i,k}(t)}{D_{i,k}^{\text{req}}(t) + \delta}, \quad \forall i \in \mathcal{I}, k \in \mathcal{K}_i(t), \quad (61b)$$

$$0 \leq s_{i,k}(t) \leq D_{i,k}^{\text{req}}(t), \quad \forall i \in \mathcal{I}, k \in \mathcal{K}_i(t), \quad (61c)$$

$$s_{i,k}(t) \leq R_{i,k}^{\text{AC}}(\mathbf{p}_i, \mathbf{b}_i; t), \quad \forall i \in \mathcal{I}, k \in \mathcal{K}_i(t), \quad (61d)$$

$$\sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}_i(t)} s_{i,k}(t) \leq R_i^{\text{BH}}(n_i; t), \quad \forall i \in \mathcal{I}, \quad (61e)$$

$$\sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}_i(t)} \sum_{m \in \mathcal{M}} p_{i,k,m}(t) \leq P_i^{\text{U}}, \quad \forall i \in \mathcal{I}, \quad (61f)$$

$$\sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}_i(t)} b_{i,k,m}(t) \leq B_m, \quad \forall i \in \mathcal{I}, m \in \mathcal{M}, \quad (61g)$$

$$\sum_{i \in \mathcal{I}} n_i(t) \leq N_B, \quad (61h)$$

$$p_{i,k,m}(t) \geq 0, \quad b_{i,k,m}(t) \geq 0, \quad s_{i,k}(t) \geq 0, \quad (61i)$$

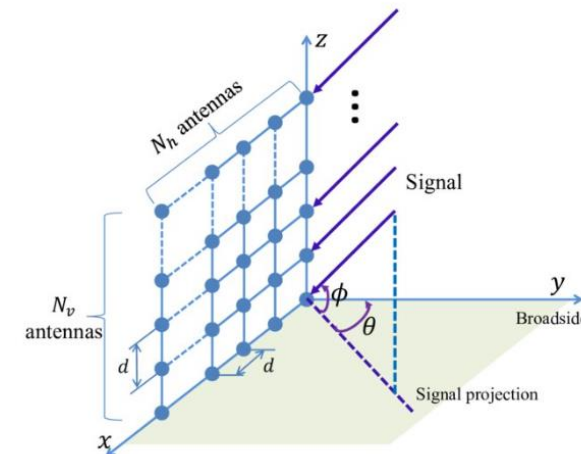
$$n_i(t) \in \mathbb{Z}_+, \quad \forall i \in \mathcal{I}. \quad (61j)$$

- Current optimization problem suffers from the running time due to many variables -> make it difficult for real-time allocation



1. Algorithm: learning-based prediction or use alternative approach
2. System design: uniform planar antenna arrays on UAVs may be consider to support directional sub-THz beams.

Uniform planar antenna array comprises multiple antennas. Arranging and grouping antenna can create multiple beam forming towards end users.



THANK YOU FOR LISTENING!

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